

THE RIGOR MYTH

**“We don't have time for projects.
We teach exam-based courses.”**

The most common objection in exam-focused schools.
The people who write the exams now disagree.

THE RESEARCH

Equal or better.

Students in rigorous project-based classrooms matched or beat their peers on the Advanced Placement exam.

Saavedra et al., 2022 · Lucas Education Research

THE COLLEGE BOARD IS ACTING

Advanced Placement is building it in.

Project-based models in six AP courses.

Official training institutes for AP teachers.

A fully project-based AP course arrives in 2026–27.

THE INTERNATIONAL BACCALAUREATE

The IB was **there first.**

Inquiry has been the point since 1968.

Interdisciplinary units are required in the MYP.

The new Systems Transformation Pathway is built on real projects.

THE SHIFT IN ONE LINE

Not added **after.**

Projects are not something a school bolts on once the
content is covered.

They are how students learn the content.

OVERSTEMED

Rigor and making were **never opposites.**

overSTEMed builds project-based STEM and AI literacy into
the courses schools already teach.
Proven in a working classroom first.